ESSAzLife Series: Book 1



VOIDY

AN ESSA CHRISTMAS STORY

BY RAISING FLOOFZ

This book is not and never will be for sale. All of the ESSAzLife books I have written and will write will be free to read and download.

Please consider the time and effort it takes to create a story, design a book, and formulate lore around it, before even considering selling my original work.

Dedication

To my Honey Bear.

Thank you for supporting me in everything I do.
And loving me through the storms.

Come closer, dear reader
and settle down for the night
as our Christmas Adventure
is about to take flight
it begins in a shop
in a not-too-far land
with a little black puppy
who awaits the touch of a hand.

Chapter 1

I used to live in a bin.

A very small, cardboard box bin.

The kind of shelf where kids with sticky fingers would rustle quickly through the stuffed dogs and other animals, searching for a plush to beg their parents for. Around me were bears that bragged, moose that never blinked, and a fox that claimed he was destined for greatness.

I didn’t brag.

I listened. I'm a very good boy.

Through the tall front windows of River & Trail Outfitters, I watched snow fall over the town through a small tear in the display. It drifted gently like the sky was shaking out tiny feathers. Christmas lights blinked on and off across the store. Music jingled overhead.

At night, when the store grew quiet, the other toys whispered hopes.

“I’ll live in a castle,” said the unicorn.

“I’ll climb mountains,” said the bear.

I didn’t know what I wanted yet.

I only knew I was waiting.

Waiting for the hands that would make me real.

Chapter 2

The bell over the door jingled one afternoon, and old air rushed in.

He walked slowly through the store, like his heart was thinking about something heavy. Snow clung to his coat. His boots squeaked faintly on the floor. He didn't look at anything for long—until he reached my aisle.

Then he stopped.

Right beneath my shelf.

His eyes lifted.

And I felt it.

That pull.

Like my stuffing leaned toward him all on its own.

His hand closed around me.

ZING.

Warmth shot through me. My ears tingled. My tail twitched for the very first time. I felt the shape of myself. I felt awake.

He smiled softly.

"I'll call you Voidy."

And just like that—

I had a name.

Chapter 3

Papa buckled me into the passenger seat. I could bark, but I still couldn't move.

Snow raced past the window as we drove. Houses glowed with Christmas lights. Inflatable snowmen guarded lawns. I watched the world blur by in sparkling streaks.

Papa talked to me, and I listened intently.

“You’re for someone special,” he said. “Mama’s gonna love you.”

Someone special. That made my heart feel bigger.

The house smelled like cinnamon and warm sugar. I waited inside wrapping paper until light burst in and Mama lifted me into her arms. Her eyes lit up like the brightest part of Christmas.

“A puppy!” she squealed.

"What a handsome boy!"

That's me, I'm the handsomest, goodest of all boys in the world.

And when she hugged me close— ZING.

Stronger than before. My nose wiggled. My ears twitched. I sneezed. Mama froze. Papa froze. I wiggled again. And just like that— I crossed from toy to true.

Chapter 4

That’s when I met them.

Stormy the Husky was first.

He crashed into me at full speed like a furry hurricane.

“HI NEW FRIEND LET’S RUN!” he barked.

Behind him came Moose the Golden Retriever and Oreo the Border Collie, both of them boys, much more calm than Stormy. Behind the boys were the girls, a German Pointer named Mocha, who stumbled clumsily into a corner as she was running to greet me, a Springer Spaniel named Mudpie, who rolled her eyes and walked the other way, and a Beagle, named Lily, who's eyes were very pretty, but she kept looking at Moose, I guess they're best friends.

Stormy immediately decided I was his best friend. He proved this by knocking me over into the leg of a chair and then barking at me excitedly.

"HELLO NEW BROTHER, COME AND PLAY THE WRESTLES WITH ME."

Although I appreciated Stormy's enthusiasm and his interest in claiming me as his best friend, I must admit that I was not consulted.

Chapter 5

The Christmas tree was beautiful.

And therefore extremely suspicious.

Stormy dared me to jump it.

I did.

The tree fought back.

Lights tangled me. Ornaments exploded into glitter. And then—

Tap.

One of Mama's snow globes tipped…

Tick.

Smash.

Silence.

Stormy slowly hid behind a pillow.

I sat, frozen in tinsel, my head hung low in apology.

Mama stared. Papa stared. Then Mama laughed so hard she had to sit down.

"Well," she said, "Santa just lost a snowstorm."

My tail wagged.

Chapter 6

That night, something unbelievable happened.

Stormy and I heard bells outside.

Real bells.

We heard a thud in the living room, and when we turned the corner, a large man in a red outfit and big black boots was leaning under the tree.

Stormy gasped. “That bag is HUGE.”

Before I knew what was happening, Stormy pushed me— Right into the sack. It whooshed closed.

I tumbled through toys, candy canes, and socks that smelled like elves. I tried to get out, but it was no use, and my worst fear happened. The sack moved.

I squeaked.

The big man muttered, “Huh. That’s new.”

When the sack opened again—

We were flying through the sky, and there were these funny looking horse things pulling the flying basket with seats.

The big man gently set me down.

Stormy fainted. I whimpered. The big man laughed.

"Well then, since you're here, you'll be helping me for the rest of the night, little pup. How would you like to be Santa's little helper?"

I barked in agreement, trying not to look down as we soared above the city.

Chapter 7

I was the one and only super pup. I helped Santa Claus deliver presents to all the good boys and girls of the world. He told me that I was a good boy. I try my very best not to fall out of the sleigh. Stormy stayed asleep, well, fainted, the entire trip. Santa finally dropped us both back at home, and we fell through the chimney.

Mama and Papa came downstairs the next morning, and Mama scooped me up.

"You can't play in the fireplace, Voidy, it's dirty."

She told Papa I needed a Bee Ayy Tee Aych. I didn't know what that was, but suddenly Stormy was hollering and splashing me in a big bowl of water with a drain. I paddled, panicking.

"HEEEEEELP I'M BEING HELD AGAINST MY WILLLLL," Stormy hollered.

"Somebody call the Pup Patrol," I yelled.

When the Bee Ayy Tee Aych was over, we went outside

My first full snow day was glorious.

Stormy ran in circles.
Mocha yelled at snowflakes.
Mudpie watched peacefully.
Moose slid accidentally down a hill and called it “exercise.”

Papa fell.
Mama laughed.
I bounced into a snowdrift and disappeared.

I was so cold by the time we went inside for presents, and it was the best day ever.

When we got inside, we could hardly believe our eyes, fully seeing all the presents

Chapter 8

The presents were everywhere.

One was for me.

A REAL DOG TOY.

Stormy and I collided mid-air.

Wrapping paper flew like birds.

Moose stole a bow.

Mudpie claimed three stockings.

It was beautiful chaos. I truly felt so happy for the first time ever. Mama and Papa were laughing, and she handed him a box. He unwrapped it and there was a tiny shirt inside. I jumped on her lap, wondering if it was for me.

"Voidy, it's not for you, it's for my Christmas present."

I tilt my head, so she knows I have no clue what she's talking about.

"Mama has a tiny baby in her belly."

A tiny master. How awesome is that! I'll be the best big brother ever!

Mama and Papa make breakfast, and everyone falls asleep, snuggling together on the couch, watching a Christmas movie.

I sigh contently, enjoying my new life as a real dog.

Chapter 9

That winter, I learned something important.

Being real isn’t about fur or bones.

It’s about:

- Who you love
- Who you protect
- Who you curl beside at night

And every night, I curled up between Papa and Mama...

With Stormy stretched across my face.

And I knew:

I was never just a toy.

Somewhere out there...

Another Puppy is in my place, in a bin or on a shelf, waiting to become real.

I wonder if they'll have a brother as annoying as Stormy, too.

Chapter 10

A holiday called Valentine's Day arrives next and there's a box shaking in the corner of the room. I march over proudly to inspect it, lifting the lid. Inside, to my surprise, is another puppy.

She barks, wagging her tail, and my friends gather around.

"My name's Dove," she says.

. She is shivering, scared. She's so very pretty.

. Mama and Papa adopted another puppy, for Dove and I to take care of when we grew up.

Dove and I named the puppy Snickers. He was a funny little Dachshund, with tiny feet. Snickers looked up at me on his first Christmas, seeing the tree and tilting his head.

. "Father, what's the true meaning of all of this?"

. I looked over at Mama, who was playing with Little Master, then back at my son.

. "Christmas is about family, Snicky. It's about being grateful for the people around you, and being grateful for everything you have. Somewhere out there, there's a puppy on a shelf, just like you were, waiting to be touched by the hand that will bring him or her to life. Although presents are nice, you should always remember that it is better to give, than to receive."

. "I saw a big man in the living room last night, Father, he said to tell you hello."

. I smiled, looking up at the Santa Ornament on the tree.

. "I'm sure he did, son. Merry Christmas, I love you."

And so, reader
as our story comes to an end
the true meaning of Christmas
is being grateful for your family
and your friends.

Even the ones we find
in the most unlikely places.

And the ones, like Voidy, who will change faces....

THE END
(For now)



Voidy is just a patient, silent Black Labrador plush, living on a shelf, and waiting for someone to give him a loving touch, that will turn him into a real puppy.
When he wakes up, he gets to exploring, and finds his way into a bit of trouble.
Follow along on this adventure, as Voidy brings a tale of laughter and Christmas Magic to all!

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Drafted December 2025
Published Privately December 2026